

sold the Octobers, but IBM neither went up nor did it slide sideways, and I lost \$6,000 in the process. Experience can be an expensive teacher, but at least I can save you some expense already with the first of my Useful Tips:

Never buy the June call nor sell the October put simultaneously, unless you know what they are

I tried to recoup with Ramada Inn at \$15, on the advice of my brother-in-law's broker. My brother-in-law plays commodities, the stock market, and tennis in Palm Springs, California. That I was getting ideas from his broker across the country via long-distance calls tells you something about the state of my relations with my own broker, but we'll discuss that later. Anyway, his broker insisted that Ramada was first in line for the next Atlantic City casino license. This it must not have received, since the stock fell straight down and hasn't seen \$15 in the 10 years since.

Prior to this Ramada deal, I got another friendly tip from a go-go dancer who'd just returned from Nassau: buy Resorts International at \$3. I realized that it was unwise for the serious investor to take buy signals from go-go dancers, and therefore ignored the recommendation. After Resorts International went to \$200 and something and split several times, I confided to a wealthy friend how I'd missed out on the 10,000 percent profit. He informed me it wasn't too late and said the stock was "still cheap at \$47" On the belief that wealthy people don't get that way by accident, I bought a couple of hundred shares at that price. Almost immediately, Resorts International retreated to \$29, where it sat for a decade, and only recently shot up to \$75 on the news of the chairman's death. This postmortem surge took place long after I'd despaired of any improvement and sold out at \$33.

Meanwhile, I picked up Charter at \$9 and got out at \$12 as the stock moved on to \$100. I counteracted this rare bit of profit with Anacomp at \$20 (which promptly plummeted to \$2³/₄) and Sykes Datatronics at \$11 (now bankrupt). I'm no stranger to metals either, having bought silver at \$19 and on its way down, not up. With other commodities, such as coffee or feeder cattle, I claim no prior